



So many testers

The technical preview for Windows 10 has currently reached 1.5 million testers
<http://dgit.in/1MWin10>



New Apple patent

Apple has a new patent for reverse AirPlay for streaming Apple TV to your iOS devices
<http://dgit.in/AirPlayPat>

Workshop



Glary Utilities lets you clean, optimise, and fix your system

Regardless, you also need to stop a few programs from starting up at the time of login. To do that, go to Run (or open Start menu and start typing) “msconfig”, go to the Startup tab and uncheck all the applications that you don’t need. Google each process name to figure that out.

Issue: Blue Screen of Death (BSOD)

This is one of the most annoying issues of all. Your computer encounters some error and gives you a blue screen before shutting down. This leaves no choice to the users but to restart. On the bright side, though, figuring out why your computer got the BSOD isn’t that tough. Install WhoCrashed to know exactly what caused the BSOD.

Other annoying issues

Issue: USB Drive isn’t showing up or working

At times, a USB port on your system might go haywire. In such a case, you’ll need to check whether the internal cables are properly connected and your BIOS still has the requisite USB header enabled. Once you’re sure there’s no problem there, you need to fire up Device Manager (run/start menu -> devmgmt.msc) and check if any of the USB port is reporting a problem. If so, you need to update and /or reinstall its driver – an option you’ll see in the properties of the port.

Issue: SSD Performance is slow

If your SSD feels slow, there could be some problem. Check to see if it’s a firmware problem on technology forums where multiple users might report the same thing. If not, benchmark it using CrystalDiskMark (<http://dgit.in/CrystalDiskM>) and see if it’s the same as mentioned in the manual. If not

check that it’s connected to a native SATA III port which is set to AHCI. Switching between AHCI and IDE can render your OS useless so create a backup disk image first. Always prefer a native port that is set to AHCI for storage devices.

Maintaining a system

Now that you know how to handle everyday quirks, it is time we also discussed how you can make sure that your computer stays in shape.

Clean, clear, optimize your registry

Much like your house, an operating system also becomes cluttered and messy over time. And much like your house, the system needs cleaning and optimization as well. Regardless of the Windows version you’ve installed on your system, it is always a good idea to defragment your hard-drive every once in a while. For that, you can use Windows’ built-in defragmentation tool called Defrag. To open it, go to Start menu and type “defrag” (without the quotes). Alternatively, you can also use free defrag tools like Auslogics’s Disk Defrag.

For advanced cleaning and optimizing, such as of registry’s, you can try CCleaner (<http://dgit.in/CCleanerD>). Additionally, we’ll also recommend you try D7 suite (<http://dgit.in/D7Suite>). Its user interface isn’t as eye catching, but it can automatically detect and fix several common issues.

Keep your computer virus free and secure

Make sure you’ve a good anti-virus suite installed on your system. The pre-installed security suite from Microsoft has certainly become better over several versions, but according to several reports, it is still not enough to combat some of the more sophisticated malware our computers are exposed to these days. Don’t think about getting more than one anti-virus, though, as it often raises conflicts like false alerts. Besides, it may even hog too much memory and thus slow down other operations.

Updating Windows is also very critical and something that you should not be neglecting. Additionally, it is also recom-

mended that you update your drivers. One of the common gateways for viruses to get into your computer is your browser. And that’s why it has become very important that you check whether your Anti-Virus suite offers internet security or not. Additionally, you can also sign up for OpenDNS (<https://www.opendns.com/>), a DNS service with easily configurable security settings.

You can also automate several of these processes to occur periodically using the scheduler in Windows. Alternatively, you can also use suites such as Tune Up Utilities or Glary Utilities.

Don’t forget the hardware Prefer running your system on UPS

If you’ve a desktop computer, prefer using a decent UPS with all the protective circuits. The good ones protect your computer from current spikes and provides you time to perform a proper shutdown. Almost every components inside your computer including and especially the network card is sensitive to fluctuations.

Cleaning internal components

Regardless of where you keep your system, they are bound to gather dust over time. You can use a vacuum cleaner to get the dust off but be careful since bringing it



CCleaner lets you clean junk off of your system.

too close to the motherboard might cause a few components to fly off (e.g. jumpers). You should also pay extra attention while going through processor fan (CPU fan) and processor heat sink. If your CPU has been getting too hot lately, you may also want to check if the thermal paste between the heat sink and processor chip has dried up. You can buy a new refill for that paste from your local computer store.